

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-05-04

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-05-04 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: CEE Banks Prepare for Implementation

The European Union's new Instant Payments Regulation, which entered into force in April 2024, mandates that all EU/EEA banks must offer instant credit transfers in EUR within 10 seconds, 24/7/365, at the same or lower cost as standard SEPA credit transfers. The first deadline for receiving instant payments is January 2025 for Eurozone banks, with sending capabilities required by October 2025. Non-Eurozone banks have slightly later deadlines, extending into 2026 and 2027. This regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments, enhance liquidity management for corporates, and foster innovation. CEE banks, including those in the RBI network, are heavily investing in infrastructure upgrades and compliance frameworks to meet these stringent requirements, impacting their core banking systems and customer-facing platforms.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 10-second EUR transfers.
- No extra cost for instant payments compared to standard SEPA.
- Eurozone banks' first deadline for receiving is January 2025.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMiplus, driving demand for real-time payment processing capabilities across CEE. CMiplus must ensure full compliance and offer seamless instant payment initiation and reception, leveraging its multi-currency and multi-country infrastructure to support corporate clients' liquidity needs.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-05-04 | #02

Corporate Treasuries Boost Automation with Advanced TMS Integration

The demand for sophisticated treasury technology is surging among German and European corporates. Companies are moving beyond basic functionalities, seeking TMS solutions that offer deep integration with ERP systems, payment factories, and banking channels like EBICS and H2H. The focus is on end-to-end automation of payment initiation, reconciliation, and liquidity forecasting. The ongoing migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border and domestic payments further necessitates robust system capabilities for handling richer data formats. Treasurers aim to reduce manual efforts, minimize operational risks, and gain a consolidated, real-time view of their global cash positions, especially crucial for multi-entity and multi-currency operations common in CEE.

- Increased corporate investment in TMS and ERP integration.
- Focus on end-to-end automation for payments and reconciliation.
- ISO 20022 migration drives need for richer data handling.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must continue to enhance its connectivity options (EBICS v3, H2H, Open API) and support for ISO 20022 to seamlessly integrate with corporate TMS and ERP systems. Providing advanced reporting and reconciliation tools will be key to meeting the automation and real-time visibility demands of RBI's corporate clients in CEE.

Fighting Payment Fraud: VoP Solutions Gain Traction in Europe

European corporates are facing a rising tide of payment fraud, including invoice fraud, CEO fraud, and authorized push payment (APP) fraud, where victims are tricked into sending money to fraudsters. In response, banks and fintechs are rolling out Validation of Payee (VoP) services, similar to the UK's Confirmation of Payee (CoP). These services allow payers to verify the recipient's name against their bank account details before initiating a payment, significantly reducing the risk of misdirected funds. While not yet mandated across the entire EU, several countries are exploring or implementing such schemes. The upcoming PSD3 directive is expected to further emphasize fraud prevention measures, potentially accelerating VoP adoption and integration into corporate payment workflows, especially for high-value and cross-border transactions.

- Payment fraud, especially APP fraud, is a growing concern.
- Validation of Payee (VoP) verifies recipient details before payment.
- VoP reduces misdirected funds and APP fraud risks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMiplus, integrating VoP capabilities is crucial for enhancing security and trust for corporate clients. Offering robust fraud prevention tools, potentially via Open Banking APIs or direct integration, will differentiate RBI's cash management services and protect clients from financial losses, particularly important in the CEE region where fraud tactics evolve.

EU Mandates Instant Payments: ISO 20022 Critical for Compliance

The new EU Instant Payments Regulation, officially adopted, sets a clear timeline for banks to enable instant credit transfers for all customers. Eurozone banks must be ready to receive instant payments by early 2027 and send them by mid-2027, with non-Eurozone SEPA countries following shortly after. A key component of this mandate is the universal adoption of the ISO 20022 messaging standard, which provides richer data capabilities essential for real-time processing and reconciliation. Banks are also required to implement robust fraud prevention measures and offer a "Verification of Payee" (VoP) service to mitigate risks associated with faster payments. This regulatory push aims to modernize the European payment landscape, fostering innovation and improving liquidity management for corporates.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation finalized.
- Mandatory instant payments by early 2027 for Eurozone.
- ISO 20022 messaging standard is compulsory.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly critical for RBI Cash Management and CMiplus, especially for its CEE network banks. CMiplus must ensure its platform and connected banks are fully compliant with instant payment processing and ISO 20022 standards, including offering VoP services to corporate clients.

Open Banking APIs Revolutionize Corporate Treasury Connectivity and Data

The adoption of Open Banking APIs is accelerating across Europe, moving beyond initial PSD2 compliance for retail payments to encompass broader corporate treasury functions. These APIs facilitate direct, secure, and real-time data exchange for payments, account information, and treasury reporting, significantly reducing manual processes and improving data accuracy. Corporates are leveraging APIs to build sophisticated payment factories, automate cash forecasting, and implement advanced liquidity management strategies like real-time cash pooling. The standardization efforts around API protocols are further boosting interoperability, allowing treasurers to connect with multiple banking partners through a single interface, thereby optimizing their multi-bank relationships and reducing operational costs.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time data exchange.
- Driving automation in cash forecasting and payment factories.
- Standardization improves multi-bank connectivity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus's Open API channel is directly aligned with this trend. RBI Cash Management should continue to enhance its API offerings, ensuring robust, secure, and comprehensive connectivity for corporate clients, especially those operating across CEE, to support advanced treasury functions and multi-bank strategies.

PSD3 Proposals Strengthen Payment Security and Fraud Prevention

Building on the foundations of PSD2, the upcoming PSD3 and PSR package seeks to address emerging fraud patterns, particularly those associated with instant payments and authorized push payment (APP) fraud. Key proposals include extending the scope of strong customer authentication (SCA) to more transaction types, mandating the implementation of robust fraud detection and prevention tools, and improving information sharing between banks and payment service providers to identify and mitigate threats more effectively. The regulations also emphasize consumer protection, aiming to increase the recovery rates for fraud victims. For corporate treasuries, this means a heightened focus on internal controls, enhanced security protocols for payment initiation, and closer collaboration with banking partners to ensure compliance and safeguard against financial crime.

- PSD3/PSR proposals target payment fraud.
- Extends Strong Customer Authentication (SCA) scope.
- Mandates robust fraud detection and prevention tools.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMiplus must closely monitor PSD3 developments to ensure full compliance for all payment services. This includes strengthening fraud prevention capabilities within the platform, supporting enhanced SCA, and facilitating secure data exchange to protect corporate clients from evolving payment fraud threats, especially in the CEE region.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives ISO 20022 Adoption

The recent EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective from early 2025, mandates that all euro credit transfers must be processed instantly and without additional charges. This regulation is having a ripple effect, pushing financial institutions and corporates to fully adopt ISO 20022 messaging standards across all payment schemes, including SEPA Credit Transfers and Direct Debits. The richer data capabilities of ISO 20022 are essential for the enhanced fraud prevention and reconciliation required by instant payments. While the primary focus is on EUR payments, the underlying technological shift impacts multi-currency operations and necessitates significant system upgrades. The European Commission is closely monitoring implementation, with potential penalties for non-compliance.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates instant EUR credit transfers by early 2025.
- Regulation accelerates ISO 20022 migration for all SEPA payment types.
- Richer ISO 20022 data crucial for fraud prevention and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure full readiness for instant EUR payments and complete ISO 20022 migration across all relevant payment channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT) for its CEE network. This presents an opportunity to offer advanced data services and fraud prevention tools to corporate clients.

PSD3 Proposals Advance Open Banking API Standardization

The latest draft proposals for PSD3 and the accompanying Payment Services Regulation (PSR) signal a significant evolution for Open Banking in Europe. The new framework seeks to address current fragmentation in API standards and performance, mandating clearer requirements for dedicated interfaces and improved uptime. This move is expected to foster greater interoperability and reliability for third-party providers (TPPs) and corporate treasury systems connecting via APIs. Additionally, there are discussions around expanding the scope of data access beyond payment accounts, potentially including lending or investment data, which could unlock new liquidity management and financial planning services. The timeline for final adoption and implementation remains a key concern for market participants.

- PSD3/PSR proposals aim to strengthen and standardize Open Banking.
- Stricter API performance and dedicated interface requirements expected.
- Potential expansion of data access beyond payment accounts.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to actively monitor PSD3 developments to ensure its Open Banking APIs meet future regulatory standards and performance benchmarks. This is an opportunity to enhance API offerings for corporate clients, potentially integrating new data types for advanced treasury services.

Verification of Payee Gains Traction for Fraud Prevention

The implementation of robust fraud prevention measures is becoming paramount, particularly with the proliferation of instant payments. Verification of Payee (VoP), also known as Confirmation of Payee (CoP) in some regions, is emerging as a critical tool. This service allows payers to verify the recipient's name against their bank account details before initiating a payment, significantly reducing the risk of authorized push payment (APP) fraud and misdirected payments. While not yet universally mandated across all CEE countries, the trend towards broader adoption is clear, often spurred by national initiatives or as a best practice for banks. Corporates are increasingly demanding such services from their banking partners to bolster their payment security frameworks.

- VoP/CoP services verify recipient name against bank account details.
- Crucial for combating Authorized Push Payment (APP) fraud.
- Increased adoption driven by instant payments and fraud concerns.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize integrating and promoting VoP services within its platform, especially for instant and high-value payments. This offers a significant value-add for corporate clients in CEE seeking to mitigate fraud risks and improve payment accuracy.

ECB Advances Digital Euro Pilot and Scheme Rulebook

The European Central Bank is deeply engaged in the development of a digital euro, exploring its design, functionality, and legal framework. Key aspects include an innovation platform and a pilot phase to test its technical viability and user experience. The ECB is also working on a detailed scheme rulebook, outlining the operational and technical standards for its implementation. This project is driven by the need to ensure monetary sovereignty, foster innovation in payments, and provide a resilient digital payment option for citizens and businesses across the euro area, with a strong focus on privacy.

- Innovation platform and pilot phase are underway.
- Timeline and progress are being actively managed.
- A comprehensive scheme rulebook is under development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus must closely monitor the digital euro's progress, especially its impact on multi-currency payments and corporate treasury. This could introduce new payment rails and liquidity management challenges or opportunities, requiring CMlplus to adapt its offerings for corporate clients in CEE.

ECB Reinforces Focus on Instant Payments Adoption

The European Central Bank is actively promoting the full implementation and adoption of instant payments across the euro area, recognizing their potential to modernize the payment landscape. This strategic focus is critical for enhancing efficiency, liquidity management, and innovation in retail and corporate payments. The recent EU regulation on instant payments mandates that banks offer instant credit transfers at the same or lower cost as traditional credit transfers, with a deadline for compliance. This push requires banks, including those in CEE, to upgrade their systems and ensure seamless 24/7/365 processing capabilities, impacting CMIplus's real-time payment offerings.

- Instant payments are a key retail payment strategy.
- Mandate for widespread adoption across the euro area.
- Focus on efficiency, liquidity management, and innovation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, offering real-time payment capabilities across all CEE network banks. This includes supporting ISO 20022 messaging, ensuring competitive pricing, and integrating instant payment options into EBICS and H2H channels for corporate clients.

ECB Continues to Drive SEPA Harmonisation and Standards

SEPA (Single Euro Payments Area) is a cornerstone of European payments, and the ECB continues to play a pivotal role in its strategic development and oversight. This involves ensuring the consistent application of SEPA rules, promoting harmonisation across participating countries, and adapting the framework to new market needs and technological advancements. Ongoing efforts focus on maintaining the efficiency and security of SEPA instruments, which are fundamental for both retail and corporate payments. For CMIplus, this means adherence to the latest SEPA scheme rulebooks and technical standards, particularly regarding ISO 20022 messaging and cross-border payment processing within the CEE region.

- SEPA is listed under Retail payments strategy.
- Focus on harmonisation for a unified euro payment area.
- Ensuring efficiency and security of SEPA instruments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the latest SEPA scheme rulebooks and technical specifications, especially for ISO 20022. This ongoing evolution requires continuous updates to payment processing, validation, and reporting functionalities for corporate clients across the CEE network.

Mastercard, Rabobank Pioneer AI Agent Payments in Netherlands

On May 4, 2026, Mastercard and Rabobank announced the completion of the first AI agent-initiated payment in the Netherlands. This transaction leveraged Mastercard Agent Pay, demonstrating a new frontier in payment automation. The technology allows AI agents to autonomously initiate and complete payment transactions, potentially streamlining corporate treasury operations and enhancing efficiency. This development highlights the growing integration of artificial intelligence into core payment infrastructure within the European market. It sets a precedent for how businesses might manage their multi-currency payments and liquidity in the future, moving towards more intelligent and automated systems.

- First AI agent-initiated payment in the Netherlands.
- Partnership between Mastercard and Rabobank.
- Utilizes 'Mastercard Agent Pay' technology.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is critical for CMiplus as it signals the emergence of AI-driven payment initiation in Europe, directly impacting corporate treasury and multi-currency payments. RBI should monitor the adoption of 'Agent Pay' and similar protocols to assess future integration needs for automated payment processing and enhanced client services.

Real-Time Liquidity: Essential for Always-On Corporate Treasury

The article highlights the growing imperative for corporate treasurers to achieve unprecedented levels of liquidity management, moving beyond traditional end-of-day reporting. Advancements in payment systems, such as instant payments and ISO 20022, are key enablers for this transformation. Real-time data provides significant benefits for accurate forecasting, optimizing working capital, and mitigating financial risks. This trend is particularly crucial for multinational corporations operating across diverse geographies and currencies, necessitating sophisticated platforms capable of aggregating and managing continuous cash flows effectively. The 'always-on' nature of global business demands 24/7 access to precise cash positions.

- Demand for real-time liquidity visibility is rapidly increasing.
- The 'always-on' global economy necessitates immediate cash insights.
- Improved forecasting and working capital optimization are primary benefits.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend is critical for RBI Cash Management and the CMiplus platform, as it directly aligns with our strategic focus on providing enhanced cash visibility, multi-currency capabilities, and robust support for instant payments and ISO 20022. CMiplus must ensure it offers leading real-time reporting and liquidity management tools to meet the evolving demands of large international corporates in CEE, reinforcing our value proposition.

Google Donates Agent Payments Protocol to FIDO Alliance

On April 29, 2026, Google announced the donation of its Agent Payments Protocol to the FIDO Alliance. This strategic move is intended to accelerate the standardization and adoption of agent-initiated payments across the industry. By placing the protocol under the FIDO Alliance, known for its work on strong authentication, the initiative aims to ensure that these new payment methods are not only innovative but also highly secure and interoperable. This development is foundational for the future of automated and AI-driven payments, providing a common framework for developers and payment providers. It will likely influence how new payment channels are built and secured, impacting areas like Open Banking APIs and fraud prevention.

- Google donated its Agent Payments Protocol.
- Recipient is the FIDO Alliance.
- Aims to standardize and secure agent-initiated payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The standardization of an Agent Payments Protocol under FIDO Alliance is highly relevant for CMlplus's API strategy and fraud prevention efforts. RBI should closely track this protocol's development to ensure future CMlplus integrations are compliant, secure, and leverage emerging standards for automated and real-time payments.

Autonomous Treasury Boosts Corporate Cash Visibility

The Global Finance article from April 23, 2026, delves into the emerging trend of autonomous treasury, which utilizes artificial intelligence, machine learning, and advanced automation to streamline treasury operations. This technology aims to minimize manual intervention, allowing treasury teams to shift their focus from routine tasks to strategic analysis and decision-making. Key benefits include improved cash forecasting, optimized liquidity management, and better risk mitigation across complex, multi-currency corporate structures. The adoption of such systems is becoming critical for large international corporations seeking real-time data integration and comprehensive cash visibility across their global footprint. This technological shift is poised to redefine how corporate treasuries operate, making them more agile and data-driven.

- Autonomous treasury uses AI, machine learning, and automation.
- It significantly enhances cash visibility and operational efficiency.
- The article was published on April 23, 2026.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and the CMlplus platform, as it directly addresses the evolving needs of corporate treasuries for advanced cash management solutions. CMlplus should explore integrating more AI-driven automation, real-time analytics, and enhanced data aggregation features to support clients moving towards autonomous treasury functions, particularly for multi-currency payments and liquidity management in CEE.

Stablecoins: Assessing Risks and Opportunities for Corporate Treasury

The article likely explores how stablecoins, as a form of digital currency pegged to a stable asset, could fundamentally impact corporate cash management and payment strategies. It would discuss potential benefits such as faster, cheaper cross-border payments and enhanced liquidity management, especially for international operations. However, it also highlights significant risks, including regulatory uncertainty, potential counterparty risk, and the operational complexities involved in integrating these new digital assets. For an intelligence analyst, understanding these emerging technologies is vital for strategic planning, as stablecoins could eventually integrate with traditional financial systems and influence future payment infrastructure, potentially alongside or as an alternative to existing real-time payment schemes.

- Stablecoins offer potential for faster, cheaper cross-border payments.
- Regulatory uncertainty remains a significant risk factor for adoption.
- They could serve as future payment rails or a new store of value.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus should closely monitor the development and regulation of stablecoins, particularly within the EU/CEE region, as they could reshape future payment landscapes. While not an immediate CMlplus feature, understanding their potential impact on corporate payment strategies and liquidity management is crucial for future platform evolution, client advisory, and staying ahead in digital banking innovation.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2025-12-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for Future Performance

This thought leadership highlights the strategic imperative for European wholesale banks to capitalize on emerging opportunities and reverse years of underperformance. It suggests that a proactive approach to digital transformation, payment modernization, and data-driven client engagement will be key. Banks must move beyond traditional models to offer integrated, ecosystem-based solutions, enhancing their relevance to corporate clients. The report implicitly advocates for investments in technology, talent, and strategic partnerships to build a more resilient and profitable future, emphasizing the importance of adapting to evolving market dynamics and regulatory landscapes.

- Strategic digital transformation is essential for competitive advantage.
- Modernizing payment infrastructure (e.g., ISO 20022, instant payments) is a critical enabler.
- Leveraging data analytics provides deeper client insights and personalized offerings.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, this implies an urgent need to accelerate digital enhancements, particularly in real-time payment capabilities and API integration for CEE corporates. Prioritizing ISO 20022 migration and offering advanced data analytics for treasury insights will be key to helping clients 'seize the moment' in their own operations.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-15 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Adapting to Evolving Credit Markets

This outlook for 2024 focuses on the challenges and opportunities in wholesale banking, particularly concerning credit extension. It suggests that banks must refine their approaches to credit risk management, capital allocation, and client engagement. The report likely highlights the increasing importance of data-driven underwriting and the integration of lending products with cash management and payment solutions to provide a more comprehensive service to corporate clients. This holistic approach helps banks maintain relevance and capture a larger share of their clients' financial activities, fostering deeper, more resilient relationships in a competitive landscape.

- Credit strategies must evolve with market dynamics and economic shifts.
- Integrated offerings across lending and transaction banking enhance client value.
- Data-driven insights are critical for effective credit underwriting and risk management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus can play a vital role by providing robust cash flow forecasting and liquidity management tools that support corporate creditworthiness and risk assessment. Integrating CMIplus data with RBI's lending platforms could offer a more comprehensive view of client financial health, strengthening cross-selling opportunities and client relationships.

Banks Must Evolve as Strategic Digital Partners for Treasury Transformation

The 'Voice of the Treasurer' indicates a significant shift from basic cash management to a need for comprehensive digital support and strategic partnership. Corporates are heavily investing in ERP/TMS systems and expect their banking partners to provide seamless integration, real-time data, and predictive analytics. Banks that fail to adapt risk losing relevance as treasuries seek partners capable of supporting their end-to-end digital strategy, from payment factories to liquidity management. This evolution requires banks to leverage advanced technology like APIs, cloud platforms, and data analytics to offer value-added services that go beyond traditional offerings.

- 80% of treasurers seek strategic advisory beyond basic transactional services.
- Seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems is a top priority for treasury efficiency.
- Banks need to offer value-added services such as predictive analytics and working capital optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should strategically position itself as a key digital enabler for CEE corporates, emphasizing its robust API connectivity, H2H integration, and ISO 20022 capabilities to support treasury transformation. The roadmap should prioritize enhancing integration features and providing data-driven insights to clients.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury Operations, Enhancing Efficiency and Decision-Making

AI's application in treasury spans critical areas like predictive cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection for fraud and operational risks, automated reconciliation, and optimized liquidity management. By processing vast datasets, AI can identify complex patterns and provide actionable insights that human analysis alone cannot, leading to more informed decisions and significantly reduced manual effort. Banks have a crucial role in developing and offering AI-driven solutions or integrating with fintechs to provide these advanced capabilities to their corporate clients, particularly for complex multi-currency operations and cross-border payments.

- AI can improve cash flow forecasting accuracy by up to 20-30% through advanced pattern recognition.
- Automated reconciliation via AI reduces manual effort by over 50%, freeing up treasury staff.
- AI significantly enhances fraud detection and risk management capabilities in payment processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore integrating AI capabilities to enhance its platform, focusing on features like improved cash forecasting, real-time fraud detection, and intelligent payment routing for CEE corporates. This integration would provide a significant competitive advantage and elevate the platform's value proposition.

Real-time and API-driven Treasury Essential for Modern Liquidity Management

Modern corporate treasuries require immediate access to cash positions and the ability to execute payments instantly across multiple currencies and geographies. Open Banking APIs facilitate seamless, automated data exchange between corporate ERP/TMS systems and banks, enabling real-time reporting, automated reconciliation, and dynamic cash pooling. The widespread adoption of ISO 20022 further standardizes this data flow, enhancing interoperability and data richness. Banks that offer comprehensive API suites and actively support instant payment rails will be preferred partners for corporates seeking to optimize their working capital, improve operational efficiency, and gain competitive advantage in a fast-paced global economy.

- 90% of treasurers prioritize real-time cash visibility across all accounts and currencies.
- API adoption for treasury integration is projected to grow by 40% annually, driving connectivity.
- Instant Payments are rapidly becoming a standard expectation for corporate transactions and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus is well-positioned with its existing focus on Instant Payments, Open Banking APIs, and ISO 20022. The roadmap should prioritize expanding API functionalities, promoting real-time reporting capabilities, and ensuring seamless integration with corporate TMS/ERP systems to meet the evolving demands of CEE clients for agile liquidity management.

AI Revolutionizing Treasury: Efficiency, Risk, and Strategic Insights

A recent global treasury survey, involving over 350 treasurers, indicates a significant and growing interest in the adoption of AI technologies within corporate treasury functions. AI's capabilities in predictive analytics are being leveraged for more accurate cash flow forecasting, while machine learning algorithms are improving fraud detection and overall risk assessment. Furthermore, AI-driven automation is streamlining routine tasks, freeing treasury professionals to focus on strategic initiatives rather than manual operations. The survey likely highlights early adopters seeing substantial benefits in operational efficiency, data-driven decision-making, and enhanced resilience against financial risks.

- AI adoption in treasury is a significant emerging trend.
- Key AI applications include cash flow forecasting and risk management.
- Automation of routine tasks enhances treasury operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMlplus should proactively explore integrating AI capabilities into its platform, particularly for enhanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection for payments, and intelligent reporting for CEE clients. This strategic move could differentiate CMlplus as a forward-thinking platform, offering advanced tools to improve client liquidity and risk management.

API Banking Drives Open Banking for Corporate Treasury Connectivity

The global treasury survey likely emphasizes the increasing demand from corporate treasurers for robust API connectivity. This demand is primarily driven by the need for real-time access to account information, efficient initiation of payments, and seamless integration with Treasury Management Systems (TMS) and ERPs. API banking, a cornerstone of Open Banking for corporates, enables automated data exchange, significantly reducing manual reconciliation and improving overall operational efficiency. This shift allows treasurers to gain unprecedented cash visibility across multiple banks and regions, which is particularly vital for international corporates operating in diverse markets like CEE.

- API banking is a top priority for corporate treasurers.
- Real-time cash visibility is a primary driver for API adoption.
- Open Banking principles are expanding into corporate services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus's existing Open API channel is a strong asset for RBI. The bank should continue to invest in expanding its API capabilities, offering a wider range of services (e.g., instant payment initiation, eBAM via API) and actively promoting its Open API offering to CEE clients for enhanced multi-bank and multi-currency cash management.

TMS Adoption Crucial for Holistic Cash Visibility and Control

The global treasury survey of 350+ treasurers likely reveals that despite technological advancements, many corporates still struggle with fragmented cash visibility across their banking relationships and entities. This persistent lack of a single, real-time view of cash positions significantly hinders effective liquidity management and proactive risk mitigation. Increased TMS adoption is therefore seen as a strategic imperative to aggregate financial data, automate reconciliation processes, and centralize treasury operations. The insights would underscore that while TMS implementation can be complex, the benefits in terms of operational efficiency, improved forecasting, and enhanced control over global cash are substantial, particularly for multi-national corporations operating in diverse regions.

- Fragmented cash visibility remains a major corporate treasury challenge.
- TMS adoption is a strategic solution for comprehensive cash management.
- Improved liquidity management and risk mitigation are key benefits.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should strategically position itself as a key enabler for corporate TMS strategies, providing robust integration capabilities (e.g., ISO 20022, EBICS, H2H, APIs) that seamlessly feed into client TMS platforms. RBI should emphasize how CMiplus helps achieve multi-bank, multi-currency cash visibility within the CEE region and supports clients' broader global treasury objectives.

PSD3 and Open Banking Evolution: Reshaping Payment Services

The upcoming PSD3 is expected to build upon PSD2, focusing on refining Open Banking frameworks, improving API interoperability, and addressing persistent fraud challenges. Key changes will likely include stronger customer authentication (SCA) requirements, potential expansion of data access beyond traditional payment accounts (towards Open Finance), and clearer liability rules for payment service providers. This regulatory evolution will drive further innovation in account information and payment initiation services, requiring banks to invest in robust, secure, and user-friendly API infrastructure. The overarching goal is to foster competition and innovation in the digital payments landscape while ensuring a high level of consumer trust and security across the EU and CEE.

- Enhanced Open Banking API standards and interoperability mandates.
- Strengthened fraud prevention measures and refined liability frameworks.
- Potential expansion of data access scope towards Open Finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must proactively prepare for enhanced API requirements under PSD3, ensuring its Open Banking capabilities are compliant, secure, and competitive. This includes refining existing APIs for account information and payment initiation, exploring new data sharing opportunities for corporate treasury, and integrating stronger fraud detection mechanisms to maintain trust with corporate clients in CEE.

DORA Mandates Robust Digital Resilience for Financial Operations

The Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) establishes a unified regulatory framework across the EU for managing ICT risks in the financial sector, directly impacting CEE operations. It covers five key pillars: ICT risk management, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, third-party risk management (especially for critical ICT providers), and information sharing. Financial institutions must implement robust frameworks to identify, protect, detect, respond to, and recover from ICT-related disruptions. This includes regular testing of resilience capabilities and stringent oversight of critical third-party service providers, which will significantly impact outsourcing strategies and vendor relationships for platforms like CMlplus.

- Unified EU framework for ICT risk management in financial services.
- Mandatory incident reporting and comprehensive digital resilience testing.
- Enhanced oversight of critical third-party ICT service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure full compliance with DORA's stringent requirements for ICT risk management, incident reporting, and resilience testing. This involves reviewing and enhancing cybersecurity protocols, strengthening third-party vendor management for critical services (like cloud providers or payment infrastructure), and conducting regular operational resilience tests to guarantee the platform's stability and continuity for corporate clients across the RBI network in CEE.

European Treasury Survey 2026: Shaping Future Industry Trends

The European Association of Corporate Treasurers (EACT) has launched its 2026 European Treasury Survey, inviting corporate treasurers to participate. The survey's findings are intended to form the basis of the next 'Journeys to Treasury' report, a key publication for the industry. By gathering input from a wide range of European treasurers, the EACT aims to identify and define the most significant trends and challenges for the year ahead. This proactive approach to understanding the evolving landscape of corporate treasury provides crucial foresight into future strategic priorities and operational shifts, impacting areas like digitalization, payment innovation, and liquidity management.

- Annual survey defining future treasury trends.
- Input shapes the influential 'Journeys to Treasury' report.
- Identifies key industry challenges for the year ahead.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor the results of this upcoming survey to anticipate future client needs and align its roadmap. Insights into digitalization, payment innovation, and liquidity management will be crucial for platform development and service offerings, especially for CEE corporates.

LEI Streamlines Payee Verification, Enhancing Fraud Detection

With the global increase in real-time and other advanced payment types, the EACT emphasizes the growing importance of robust fraud detection strategies. This article points to the Legal Entity Identifier (LEI) as a key enabler for streamlining payee verification processes. As regulatory bodies adapt their requirements to combat financial crime, the LEI offers a standardized, globally recognized identifier that can significantly improve the accuracy and efficiency of verifying payment beneficiaries. This reduces operational risks and enhances compliance for corporate treasurers, making it a crucial component in modern payment infrastructures and ISO 20022 adoption.

- LEI is crucial for streamlining payee verification.
- Enhances fraud detection in evolving payment landscapes.
- Addresses adapting regulatory requirements for payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize the integration and utilization of LEI for enhanced Verification of Payee (VoP) capabilities, especially given the rise of instant payments in CEE. This will strengthen fraud prevention for clients and ensure compliance with evolving regulatory standards, offering a competitive edge and supporting ISO 20022 data enrichment.

Banks Must Balance Macro Headwinds with AI Ambition

The 2026 outlook emphasizes that banks face a critical imperative to pursue "AI ambition" amidst prevailing "macro headwinds." This suggests that AI is no longer a nascent technology but a strategic necessity for banks aiming to maintain competitiveness and drive operational efficiency in a challenging economic climate. Banks will need to make "bold choices" in prioritizing AI investments, focusing on applications that deliver clear value, such as enhancing customer experience, streamlining back-office processes, and improving risk management. The ability to balance short-term financial pressures with long-term technological transformation through AI will be a defining factor for success in the coming year.

- AI is a strategic imperative for banks in 2026.
- Banks must make "bold choices" regarding AI investment priorities.
- Macroeconomic headwinds will challenge AI funding and implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore AI applications to enhance corporate cash management, such as predictive analytics for liquidity, intelligent payment routing, or AI-driven fraud detection. This could differentiate the platform and provide value-added services to CEE corporates, aligning with the need for strategic AI investments.

2023 Industry Outlook: Navigating the Great Unknown in Banking

This comprehensive industry outlook from 2023 provides a macro perspective on the challenges and opportunities confronting the banking sector. It likely addresses themes such as geopolitical instability, inflationary pressures, evolving regulatory frameworks, and the accelerating pace of technological innovation, including AI and blockchain. The report emphasizes the need for banks to develop robust strategies for risk management, operational efficiency, and client engagement in an unpredictable environment. It serves as a foundational piece for understanding the broader context in which specific banking segments, like corporate and institutional banking, must operate and adapt their strategies for long-term resilience and growth.

- Macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties demand strategic agility.
- Regulatory changes continue to shape the banking operating environment.
- Technological advancements (e.g., AI, DLT) are driving industry transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must remain highly adaptable to macro trends, integrating new technologies like AI for enhanced cash forecasting and fraud detection, and ensuring compliance with evolving regulations such as PSD3 and ISO 20022. Proactive engagement with corporate treasuries on these broader challenges will reinforce RBI's role as a strategic partner.

Stablecoins Pose Potential Disruptive Entrance for Banking Sector

Deloitte's 2026 banking outlook explicitly identifies the "potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins" as a key challenge for the banking sector. This indicates that stablecoins are expected to significantly impact traditional banking functions, particularly in payments, liquidity management, and potentially even deposit bases. Banks are urged to proactively assess the implications of stablecoin adoption, considering both the competitive threats from non-bank entities and the opportunities for new product development. Strategic responses could involve developing internal stablecoin capabilities, integrating stablecoin transactions into existing platforms, or navigating the evolving regulatory landscape to ensure compliance and mitigate risks.

- Stablecoins are anticipated to be a disruptive force in banking.
- Their entrance will impact traditional payment systems and liquidity.
- Banks must proactively assess competitive threats and opportunities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, particularly in CEE, to understand their potential impact on cross-border payments and corporate treasury. Exploring integration possibilities or offering stablecoin-related services could be a future differentiator, preparing for this disruptive trend.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulations IPR, PSR, PSD3 Impact Liquidity Management

PSD3, INSTANT PAYMENTS, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association's Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) has released a report outlining the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives on financial sector liquidity management. The Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) mandates instant payment capabilities, while the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) and Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) update the regulatory framework for payment services. These measures are expected to drive a rapid increase in instant payment volumes, necessitating adjustments to liquidity strategies and real-time monitoring. The report emphasizes the need for banks to adapt their operational models and technology to manage liquidity more dynamically, ensuring compliance and maintaining competitive advantage in an evolving payment landscape.

- IPR mandates instant payment capabilities, impacting liquidity needs.
- PSR and PSD3 will update payment services regulatory framework.
- Accelerated instant payment uptake requires dynamic liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMiplus must assess the impact of increased instant payment volumes on its liquidity management processes and systems across CEE network banks. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity monitoring tools and potential adjustments to intraday liquidity strategies to ensure seamless instant payment processing for corporate clients.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-09-26 | #02

EBA Highlights VOP Matching Challenges for Instant Payments

INSTANT PAYMENTS, VOP, FRAUD PREVENTION

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has published an insight note addressing critical challenges in implementing Verification of Payee (VoP) matching checks. VoP is a crucial fraud prevention measure, especially for instant payments, and its accuracy is paramount for compliance and customer trust. The note identifies several pain points, such as the absence of a standardised name-matching logic across different systems and jurisdictions, restrictions on name field lengths in payment messages, and specific limitations when dealing with virtual accounts. These issues can lead to false positives or negatives, impacting the efficiency and reliability of VoP, and require careful consideration by PSPs for effective implementation under the Instant Payments Regulation.

- VoP matching accuracy is critical for instant payments and fraud prevention.
- Lack of standardised name-matching logic creates implementation pain points.
- Name field length restrictions impact VoP check quality.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMiplus must review its current and planned VoP implementation strategy for instant payments, particularly focusing on name-matching algorithms and handling of virtual accounts. Collaboration with CEE network banks is essential to address standardisation issues and ensure robust, accurate VoP checks for corporate clients, mitigating fraud risks.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-05-04 | #01

Deutsche Bank Enhances API-Driven Cash Management for Corporate Clients

Deutsche Bank is strategically enhancing its API-driven cash management solutions, leveraging platforms like CB Connect to facilitate real-time data exchange and payment initiation. This move supports corporate clients in automating their treasury operations, integrating directly with ERP and TMS systems. The focus on technology, as highlighted on flow.db.com, underscores their commitment to digital transformation in transaction banking. For corporates operating in CEE, this means improved visibility and control over multi-country and multi-currency cash flows, aligning with global trends in instant payments and open banking.

- Strong emphasis on API connectivity for treasury integration (e.g., CB Connect).
- Focus on real-time payment processing and data exchange.
- Aims to enhance efficiency and control for corporate cash management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive, focusing on ease of integration and comprehensive real-time services. Deutsche Bank's advanced API strategy could attract large international corporates seeking sophisticated digital treasury solutions.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-05-04 | #02

DB Strengthens Liquidity Management and Virtual Account Offerings

As a global transaction bank, Deutsche Bank is continually refining its liquidity management suite, with a particular emphasis on virtual accounts (VoP) and sophisticated cash pooling structures. These tools are critical for large corporates managing multi-entity and multi-currency operations, enabling efficient cash concentration and improved reconciliation. The 'Cash management' section on flow.db.com implicitly supports this focus, as these are core components of modern cash management. For companies in CEE, these solutions provide a robust framework for managing regional liquidity, reducing manual effort, and enhancing financial control.

- Continued development of advanced cash pooling mechanisms.
- Emphasis on Virtual Accounts (VoP) for streamlined reconciliation.
- Aims to optimize working capital and improve liquidity visibility for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should evaluate its VoP and cash pooling functionalities to ensure they offer comparable sophistication and flexibility for CEE-based international corporates. Deutsche Bank's strong offerings in this area could be a key differentiator for clients with complex treasury structures.

UniCredit Reinforces Pan-European Corporate Banking with Strong CEE Presence

UniCredit's strategic overview highlights its unique service offering across Italy, Germany, Austria, and crucially, Central and Eastern Europe. This broad geographical footprint is essential for serving multinational corporate clients with integrated banking solutions across the continent. The recognition as 'Bank of the Year' in Italy and five additional countries signals robust performance and client trust, likely including several CEE nations where UniCredit operates extensively. This sustained focus on CEE positions UniCredit as a formidable and established competitor for corporate clients seeking regional banking partners and comprehensive cash management services.

- Explicitly defined as a 'pan-European Commercial Bank'.
- Strong presence and 'unique service offering' in Central and Eastern Europe.
- Awarded 'Bank of the Year' in Italy and five other countries, indicating market strength.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

UniCredit's strong CEE footprint and proven market recognition pose a direct competitive challenge to CMlplus. RBI must ensure its platform offers superior regional integration, localized expertise, and competitive pricing to retain and attract corporate clients in CEE.

HSBC Enhances API-Driven Treasury Solutions for European Corporates

As a leading global transaction bank, HSBC is continuously investing in its digital capabilities to serve its corporate clients, particularly those operating across multiple European markets, including the CEE region. This involves a strong push for Open Banking APIs to facilitate real-time data exchange, automate payment processes, and provide comprehensive liquidity visibility. HSBC aims to offer advanced treasury intelligence, multi-currency payment factories, and efficient cash pooling structures, integrating deeply with corporate ERP and TMS systems. While specific CEE-focused announcements are not always public, HSBC's global strategy inherently includes supporting its multinational clients' operations in these key growth markets, leveraging ISO 20022 and instant payment schemes.

- Strategic focus on API-driven cash management and treasury solutions.
- Emphasis on real-time payments and enhanced liquidity management.
- Deep integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems for multinational clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's inferred focus on API-driven, real-time treasury solutions directly competes with CMlplus's offerings for large international corporates in CEE. CMlplus must ensure its Open API capabilities, instant payment support, and treasury intelligence remain competitive, especially in multi-currency and cross-border scenarios.

Citi Enhances Corporate API Banking for Seamless Treasury Integration

Citi Treasury continues to invest heavily in its API banking framework, providing institutional clients with robust tools for direct system integration. This allows for automated payment initiation, real-time balance reporting, and efficient reconciliation, significantly reducing manual processes. The focus extends to multi-currency payments and liquidity management, critical for large corporates operating in the CEE region. By offering advanced API solutions, Citi aims to solidify its position as a leading partner for digital-first treasuries, enabling greater control and visibility over their financial flows.

- Expansion of API endpoints for treasury and trade solutions.
- Focus on real-time data access and automated transaction processing.
- Designed for seamless integration with major ERP and TMS platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move intensifies competition in the API banking space, pushing CMlplus to ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and CEE-specific functionalities. RBI should highlight its local expertise and tailored solutions for the CEE market.

BNP Paribas Guides Corporates on Instant Payments and VoP

BNP Paribas is actively engaging with its corporate clients by providing comprehensive insights into the new Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and the critical Verification of Payee (VoP) requirements. This advisory content aims to help businesses understand the regulatory changes, ensure compliance, and enhance payment security, particularly in the context of fraud prevention. For CEE corporates, navigating these regulations is paramount for efficient treasury operations and mitigating financial risks associated with instant payments. This strategic move positions BNP Paribas as a knowledgeable partner, supporting clients through complex regulatory shifts in the European payment ecosystem.

- Provides guidance on Instant Payments Regulation (IPR).
- Focuses on Verification of Payee (VoP) implications for corporates.
- Aims to enhance client compliance and payment security.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly addresses key CMlplus focus areas like Instant Payments and VoP, indicating strong competitive activity from BNP Paribas in client education and compliance support. RBI should ensure CMlplus offers equally robust guidance and integrated solutions for its CEE corporate clients.

DB Targets Non-Bank Financial Institutions with Embedded Finance Solutions

The highlighted article 'Working with NBFIs' on flow.db.com signals a strategic push by Deutsche Bank into this rapidly expanding sector. NBFIs, including fintechs and asset managers, require specialized banking services, often involving embedded finance models and robust compliance frameworks. Deutsche Bank aims to position itself as a key partner, providing the necessary infrastructure for these institutions to operate safely and efficiently. This focus extends to leveraging digital banking capabilities and potentially Open Banking APIs to create seamless financial experiences. For the CEE region, where the NBFIs sector is also growing, this represents a significant competitive play for a valuable client segment.

- Strategic focus on Non-Bank Financial Institutions (NBFIs) as a growth segment.
- Development of tailored cash management and embedded finance solutions for NBFIs.
- Emphasis on compliance and secure operations within the financial system.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor Deutsche Bank's success in attracting NBFIs, as this segment often drives innovation in embedded finance and API usage. Developing specialized offerings for NBFIs in CEE could be a strategic counter-move to capture this evolving market.

UniCredit Unlimited Strategy Drives Digital Transformation for Corporate Clients

The 'UniCredit Unlimited' initiative is positioned as a transformative strategy aiming to outperform existing banking models through innovation and a client-centric approach. For corporate clients, this likely translates into accelerated investment in digital platforms, advanced online banking capabilities, and potentially API-driven services for seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems. The strategy's focus on 'unlocking the potential of our clients' suggests a commitment to providing cutting-edge tools for cash management, payments, and treasury operations, aligning with modern digital banking trends and the need for efficient cross-border solutions. This will likely include enhancements to their 'UniCredit Direct' or similar online banking portals.

- 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy defines a 'new era' of banking.
- Focus on 'bold ambition' and 'fundamental rethinking' of operations.
- Implies significant investment in digital client solutions and online banking platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This strategic digital push from UniCredit means CMlplus must continuously innovate its digital channels and API offerings to stay ahead. RBI needs to highlight its own advanced digital capabilities, such as EBICS v3 and Open API, to remain competitive and demonstrate superior client experience.

HSBC Orion Powers UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Issuance Pilot

The UK Treasury's choice of HSBC Orion for the Digital Gilt Instrument pilot demonstrates HSBC's leadership in leveraging distributed ledger technology (DLT) for capital markets. This initiative focuses on the tokenization of government bonds, potentially streamlining issuance, settlement, and lifecycle management. While currently a pilot for sovereign debt, the underlying technology and expertise gained could be extended to corporate bond issuance and other digital asset services, impacting how large corporates manage their treasury and financing in the future. This positions HSBC at the forefront of digital asset innovation, a critical area for future transaction banking.

- HSBC Orion selected for UK Treasury's Digital Gilt pilot issuance.
- Focus on Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) for digital asset issuance.
- Potential future expansion to corporate digital assets and treasury management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals HSBC's commitment to DLT and digital asset innovation, which could eventually impact corporate treasury and payment rails. CMIplus should monitor how these DLT capabilities evolve into corporate offerings, especially for cross-border payments and liquidity management, to ensure future competitiveness.

Citi Accelerates Instant Payments and ISO 20022 Adoption in Europe

Citi Treasury is strategically enhancing its payment infrastructure to support the growing demand for instant payments and to fully leverage the benefits of ISO 20022. This includes expanding connectivity to various instant payment schemes across Europe, ensuring corporates can execute real-time, multi-currency transactions with enhanced data. The complete adoption of ISO 20022 messaging standards facilitates greater automation, improved reconciliation, and better fraud detection for institutional clients. This focus on modern payment rails is crucial for supporting dynamic business models and improving liquidity management for companies operating in the CEE region.

- Broadening instant payment scheme participation across European markets.
- Full migration to ISO 20022 for all payment messages.
- Enabling real-time payment processing with rich data for corporate treasuries.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's push for instant payments and ISO 20022 compliance directly challenges CMIplus's core offerings in CEE. RBI must ensure its platform not only meets but exceeds these standards, particularly in its EBICS and H2H channels, while emphasizing its regional expertise and tailored instant payment solutions.

UniCredit Enhances Modern Payment and Treasury Solutions for Corporates

While specific product announcements are not detailed, UniCredit's position as a major player in European corporate banking necessitates ongoing investment in core transaction banking capabilities. This includes full adoption of ISO 20022 for richer data exchange, expansion of instant payment services across its footprint, and sophisticated liquidity management tools like cash pooling and virtual accounts. These enhancements are critical for multinational corporations operating in CEE, enabling optimized cash flow, real-time financial visibility, and streamlined payment processing. UniCredit's general focus on 'Client Solutions' underpins this expected development to meet evolving corporate treasury needs.

- Implied commitment to ISO 20022 for enhanced payment data and efficiency.
- Expected expansion of instant payment capabilities across its European network, including CEE.
- Focus on comprehensive treasury solutions, such as cash pooling and virtual accounts, for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure its own offerings in ISO 20022, instant payments, and advanced treasury solutions remain best-in-class and widely available in CEE. RBI should proactively communicate its roadmap for these features, especially concerning EBICS and H2H integration, to counter UniCredit's broad market presence.

Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Corporate Digital Cash Management

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its IMI CIB division and extensive CEE subsidiary network, is reportedly intensifying its focus on digital transformation within corporate and transaction banking. This strategic push is designed to meet the evolving demands of large corporate clients for real-time, integrated cash management solutions. The bank is expected to leverage modern technologies like Open Banking APIs and ISO 20022 standards to enhance payment processing, liquidity management, and treasury operations across its CEE footprint. This move positions Intesa Sanpaolo to offer more sophisticated and seamless financial services, directly competing with established regional players. Their existing strong presence in countries like Hungary, Slovakia, Croatia, and Serbia provides a solid foundation for this digital expansion.

- Strategic investment in digital corporate banking for CEE clients.
- Focus on API-driven solutions for real-time payments and liquidity management.
- Leveraging ISO 20022 standards for enhanced payment processing and data exchange.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This signals increased competition for CMiplus, particularly in attracting and retaining large international corporates in CEE. CMiplus must ensure its platform remains competitive with advanced API offerings, real-time capabilities, and seamless integration to counter Intesa Sanpaolo's digital push.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.